

ANANYA PRADHAN

Development Economist & Quantitative Labour Researcher

Research Associate, V.V. Giri National Labour Institute, Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India

Research Contributor, PLFS Data Story (India Labour Observatory & Digital Labour Tech)

Alumna, Centre for Informal Sector and Labour Studies (CISLS), Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), New Delhi

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PROFILE & RESEARCH AGENDA

Quantitative Development Economist and Labour Researcher with postgraduate degrees from Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) and Utkal University, UGC-NET qualified in Economics, with over **3 years of cumulative research experience** in empirical micro-econometrics, primary digital survey design (SurveyCTO, KoBoToolbox), automated Stata High-Frequency Check (HFC) data quality pipelines, and applied labour market research. Contributed empirical research to the PLFS 2024–25 data story “*India’s Labour Market in 2025: Structural Cleavages, Gender Gaps, and the Educated Youth Paradox*” (first published at Digital Labour Tech and featured on the India Labour Observatory). Currently Research Associate at the **V.V. Giri National Labour Institute** (Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India), evaluating Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI, e-Shram), social security floors, Direct Benefit Transfers (DBT), and international labour governance across BRICS economies. Proven background leading multi-site CAPI field operations, administering gender-disaggregated household and worker surveys, and executing Oaxaca-Blinder wage decompositions on national microdata.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Empirical Labour Economics · Gender Wage Discrimination & Structural Cleavages · Informal & Platform Labour

Policy & Governance: Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI, e-Shram, DBT) · Social Protection Floors · BRICS Labour Regimes

Methods: Applied Micro-econometrics (Oaxaca-Blinder) · Primary Field Surveys & CAPI · Automated Stata HFC Quality Pipelines

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Research Contributor

2025

India Labour Observatory & Digital Labour Tech

New Delhi, India

- Contributed empirical analysis to the PLFS 2024–25 data story “*India’s Labour Market in 2025: Structural Cleavages, Gender Gaps, and the Educated Youth Paradox*”, first published at Digital Labour Tech and featured on the India Labour Observatory.
- Analyzed gender gaps in labour force participation, structural wage disparities, and youth unemployment patterns using Periodic Labour Force Survey unit-level microdata.

Research Associate

Mar 2026 -- Present

V.V. Giri National Labour Institute (VVGNI) --- Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India

NOIDA, India

- Project:** *Shaping the Future of Labour in BRICS: The Role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Emerging Technologies.*
- Lead researcher investigating government social security schemes, digital welfare delivery, and Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) programs for unorganised and platform workers, benchmarked against the ILO Social Security Floor.
- Evaluating Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) integrations (e-Shram, MGNREGS, DBT portals), assessing welfare access, aggregator onboarding, and structural gender barriers in digital welfare access.
- Conducting comparative cross-country policy research on AI adoption, digital welfare registries, and informal worker protections across BRICS member states (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa).
- Designed and programmed CAPI survey instruments (SurveyCTO / KoBoToolbox) with validation logic, audit logging, and gender-disaggregated modules for national-level policy evaluation.
- Engineered automated Stata High-Frequency Check (HFC) scripts to continuously monitor enumerator productivity, detect statistical anomalies, and guarantee publication-ready microdata.
- Coordinated technical proceedings and prepared presentations for the Final Meeting of the BRICS Labour Research Network under India’s Presidency.

Field Investigator

Jan 2026 -- Mar 2026

ICSSR-Sponsored National Research Project, Christ University

Ghaziabad / Uttar Pradesh, India

- **Project:** *Sustainability of Digital Jobs — Assessing Youth Livelihood Opportunities in Uttar Pradesh.*
- Administered structured CAPI surveys via KoBoToolbox across geographically dispersed districts in Uttar Pradesh, managing data capture for 100+ respondents with gender-disaggregated modules on youth digital employment.
- Implemented real-time daily data auditing and error correction protocols, maintaining zero sample attrition across survey waves.
- Coordinated local district administrative clearances and respondent mobilization under strict research ethics protocols.

Field Investigator / Research Assistant

Nov 2024 -- Jan 2025

Centre for Informal Sector and Labour Studies (CISLS), Jawaharlal Nehru University

New Delhi, India

- **Project:** *Mixed-Methods Empirical Study on Platform-Based Labour and Gender in Delhi NCR.*
- Designed, coded, and pilot-tested survey instruments with built-in validation constraints, skip logic, and geo-referencing.
- Administered 60 in-depth primary interviews across Delhi NCR app-based delivery and transport gig workers, analyzing algorithmic control, piece-rate volatility, and gendered barriers to entry. Assisted in Stata cleaning, coding, and econometric analysis.

Research Support --- Rural Communities & Livelihood Documentation

Oct 2018 -- Dec 2019

CIVICUS (via Video Volunteers)

Odisha, India

- Translated, transcribed, and synthesized primary field documentation from Odia and Bengali to English for an international civil society advocacy consortium.
- Documented livelihoods, community resource rights, food security, and collective bargaining among marginalized farming, marine fishing, and women's Self-Help Groups (SHGs) across coastal and tribal Odisha.

PRIMARY FIELDWORK & SURVEY ADMINISTRATION EXPERIENCE

Uttar Pradesh Youth Livelihoods (ICSSR, 2026)

100+ structured CAPI interviews across multiple UP districts; youth digital skilling, platform livelihoods, and gender divides.

Delhi NCR Platform Workers (JNU, 2024–25)

60 in-depth surveys of gig/platform workers; algorithmic dispatching, wage deductions, and working-hour distributions.

Munirka Urban Informal Workers (Delhi, 2018)

35 structured interviews with informal workers (mess workers, security guards, domestic staff) assessing wage exploitation and living conditions.

Kalahandi & Niyamgiri Hills (Odisha, 2018)

Participatory rural appraisal & interviews with Dongaria Kondh tribal households; tenurial rights, bauxite mining resistance, and forest economies.

Kendrapara Women's SHGs (Odisha, 2016)

Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) with women's micro-credit groups; agricultural credit linkages, bank linkage schemes, and debt cycles.

Khamarsahi Village Caste & Labour Study (Odisha, 2016)

Field research on Scheduled Caste agricultural labourers; wage discrimination, tied labour, and social exclusion.

India's Labour Market in 2025: Structural Cleavages, Gender Gaps, and the Educated Youth Paradox 2026

Data Story, Digital Labour Tech & India Labour Observatory (with Abhinav Kumar)

Research Publication

Empirical investigation of Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS 2024–25) microdata diagnosing structural gender participation gaps, educated youth unemployment, and social group wage disparities. First published at Digital Labour Tech and featured on the India Labour Observatory.

[View Interactive Story & Data ↗](#)

Global Value Chains in Extractive Industries: Mining, Labour Precarity, and Value Capture in Odisha 2021

Working Paper (Seminar Paper, CISLS, JNU --- Advised by Prof. Praveen Jha)

Research Paper

Empirical political economy inquiry into transnational bauxite mining and alumina refining (Vedanta Limited) in Lanjigarh and Niyamgiri, Odisha. Draws on 35 semi-structured worker interviews, 5 FGDs, and Indian Bureau of Mines longitudinal data to analyze multi-tiered subcontracting, labour control regimes, and agrarian dispossession.

[Download Working Paper PDF ↗](#)

Gender-Based Wage Discrimination in India: An Oaxaca-Blinder Decomposition Analysis 2019

M.A. Thesis, Centre for Informal Sector and Labour Studies (CISLS), JNU

New Delhi, India

Econometric decomposition using Periodic Labour Force Survey unit-level data in Stata. Partitioned the male-female wage gap into explained human capital endowments and unexplained structural discrimination coefficients across formal salaried and informal casual employment.

Caste System and Patterns of Discrimination in Rural Labour Markets 2016

Field Research Monograph, Centre for Study of Discrimination and Exclusion (CSDE), JNU *Supervised by Prof. Y. Chinna Rao*

Empirical investigation of caste hierarchies, debt interlinkages, and agricultural wage discrimination among Scheduled Caste informal workers in Khamarsahi village, Kendrapara, Odisha.

Modes of Production, Globalisation, and Labour Processes: A Relational Political Economy Analysis 2018

Working Paper / Academic Essay, CISLS, Jawaharlal Nehru University

New Delhi, India

Relational political economy analysis tracing class differentiation from primitive accumulation to contemporary international financial capital, transnational corporate monopolisation, and structural informalisation.

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EDUCATION

M.A. in Labour and Development Studies 2017 -- 2019

Centre for Informal Sector and Labour Studies (CISLS), Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU)

New Delhi, India

- **Grade:** 6.25 / 9.0 (First Class equivalent)
- **Core Coursework:** Advanced Development Economics, Rural Labour Markets, Advanced Research Methods, Applied Statistics & Econometrics, Political Economy of Development, Informal Sector in Developing Economies.
- **Thesis:** *Gender-Based Wage Discrimination in India: An Oaxaca-Blinder Decomposition Analysis using PLFS Data.*

M.A. in Analytical and Applied Economics 2015 -- 2017

Department of Analytical and Applied Economics, Utkal University

Bhubaneswar, Odisha

- **Grade:** 65.67% (First Class)
- **Core Coursework:** Econometric Theory, Mathematical Economics, Microeconomic Theory, Macroeconomics, Public Economics, Development Policy.

- **Honours:** First Class with Distinction
- **Subjects:** Economic Theory, Indian Economy, Monetary Economics, Quantitative Techniques.

CERTIFICATIONS & SPECIALIZED METHODOLOGICAL TRAINING

- **UGC-NET Qualified in Economics** (University Grants Commission, National Eligibility Test for Assistant Professorship).
- **Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations** — J-PAL / MITx (Coursework in power calculations, cluster RCT designs, balance checks, and field protocols — in progress).
- **Data Analysis for Social Scientists** — MITx (Probability, regression, causal inference, and hypothesis testing — in progress).
- **Survey Methodology, Sampling Techniques & Field Protocols** — Society for Social and Economic Research (SSER), New Delhi (2018).
- **Post Graduate Diploma in Computer Applications (PGDCA)** (Database architecture, programming fundamentals, spreadsheet algorithms).

COMPUTATIONAL & METHODOLOGICAL TOOLKIT

Econometrics & Stats:	Stata (Primary: reproducible .do scripting, High-Frequency Checks [HFCs], panel FE/RE, Oaxaca-Blinder decompositions, PLFS microdata harmonisation), R (dplyr, tidyr, ggplot2, spatial sf), Python (pandas, numpy, statsmodels, Playwright, BeautifulSoup).
Digital Survey CAPI:	SurveyCTO & KoBoToolbox / ODK (Advanced XLSForm programming, complex constraint logic, cascading selects, GPS geotrace/geopoint, audit log monitoring, server pipelines).
Geospatial / GIS:	QGIS (Thematic cartography, shapefile manipulation, district boundary mapping), Google Earth Pro (spatial referencing, ground truth verification).
Typesetting & Code:	Typst (Modern vector publishing), Quarto (.qmd), LaTeX, Git / GitHub version control, Markdown, HTML5/CSS3.
Languages:	Odia (Native — full professional proficiency in speaking, reading, and writing), English (Bilingual — academic writing and presentation proficiency), Hindi (Professional working proficiency — fluent field administration and translation), Bengali (Working reading and speaking proficiency).

Academic and professional references available upon request.